Course Detail Page — Critical Review

Problems

1. Lost context — no merit/chance indicator The student clicked a card on the dashboard that said "High Chance" or "Low Chance". When they land here, that context vanishes. They have to remember which tier this course was in. This is the single biggest gap — the page should reinforce *why* this course was shown to them.

2. "About" section is filler text When description and description_en are empty (which is common), the fallback generates generic text like *"This Asasi programme in Umum prepares students for careers in Umum."* That's worse than showing nothing — it looks broken. (page.tsx:124-125)

3. Quick Facts has redundancy and jargon

- "Field: Umum" and "Department: Umum" say the same thing twice — and "Umum" (General) isn't useful
- "WBL: No" means nothing to a 17-year-old. Most courses show "No" anyway, which is just noise
- "Level" is already shown as a badge in the header — repeated here

4. Department badge in header wastes space Line 87-89 shows course.department as a grey pill badge. When department is "Umum", this adds zero value. And it's already in Quick Facts.

5. Apply button is buried The most important action — actually applying — is a tiny button inside each institution card. Meanwhile, "Save This Course" gets the primary blue full-width button treatment. The priorities are inverted.

6. Available data not shown These fields exist in the database but aren't on the page:

- **Institution address** — students need to know where they'll be studying
- **Institution website URL** (institution.url) — different from the course application link
- **Practical allowance** — practical_allowance is fetched but never displayed
- **Latitude/longitude** — could at minimum show "Distance from you" or link to Google Maps

7. No course name in English The title shows only the Malay course name (course.course). No English translation exists in the model, but the headline_en partially serves this purpose — when present it should be more prominent.

8. "#" artefact in course name The screenshot showed "Asasipintar Ukm #" — this is a data quality issue (trailing #). The frontend should strip these.

9. Save state doesn't persist isSaved starts as false every page load (line 17). The API call to saveCourse works, but when the student returns, it always shows "Save" not "Saved". The initial state should come from the API.

10. No way to discover related courses The page is a dead end. No "Similar Courses", no "Other courses at this institution", no "Students who viewed this also viewed". The student must go back to the dashboard to explore further.

Recommendations (prioritised)

High impact, low effort:

Change	Why
Add merit chance badge to header (High/Fair/Low pill)	Restores dashboard context. Pass merit_label as a query param or fetch from eligibility endpoint
Hide "About" when description is empty instead of generating filler	Filler text looks broken, removing it is cleaner
Strip Quick Facts to useful items only — remove Field when same as Department, remove WBL when false, remove Level (already in header badge)	Reduces noise
Trim course name — strip trailing #, *, whitespace	Quick data cleanup, can do in frontend or fix in DB
Show institution address — it's already in the database	Students need this for planning
Show institution website link — institution.url is available but not rendered	Let students research the institution
Show practical allowance alongside monthly allowance	Already fetched, just not displayed

Medium effort, high value:

Change	Why
Restructure actions — make "Apply" the hero button (per-institution), demote "Save" to an icon/secondary	Matches actual student intent
Persist saved state — have the API return whether the student has saved this course	Prevents confusion on revisit
Add a "Your Chance" section in the sidebar showing merit score vs cutoff with a visual bar	This is the most decision-relevant data for the student
Add "Related Courses" section at the bottom — same field, same level, or same institution	Reduces dead-end bounces

Lower priority (nice to have):

Change	Why
Link institution to Google Maps using lat/lng	Helps students visualise distance
Add PISMP to LevelBadge colour map	Currently falls through to grey
Fee comparison table when multiple institutions offer the course	Helps decision-making

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Suggested new layout (top to bottom)

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┌─ Course Header ──────────────────────────────────────┐
│  [Asasi]  [High Chance ●]                            │
│  Asasipintar UKM                                     │
│  "Your bridge to a degree in science at UKM"         │
│  Umum · 2 semesters · Work-Based Learning            │
│                                  [♡ Save]            │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘

┌─ Your Chance (sidebar or inline) ────────────────────┐
│  Your merit: 54.67  │  Cutoff: ~50  │  High Chance   │
│  ▓▓▓
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┌─ Similar Courses (future) ──────────────────────────────┐
│  [Course Card] [Course Card] [Course Card]          │
└─────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
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← Back to Recommendations

Want me to implement any of these changes? I'd suggest starting with the high-impact, low-effort batch — the "About" section fix, Quick Facts cleanup, showing address/website/practical allowance, and trimming the course name. That's all within the current data and can be done in one pass.